

# DEEKSHA ARYA

(SHE/HER)

Website: <https://instagram.com/dance.deeksha.arya>

Email: [dance.deeksha.arya@gmail.com](mailto:dance.deeksha.arya@gmail.com)



Bharatanatyam



Mohiniattam

## RESUMÉ

I am Deeksha, and I am an exponent of two different types of Indian classical dance forms, namely Bharatanatyam and Mohiniattam. I have had over 25 years of training in Bharatanatyam, and 15 years of training in Mohiniattam. I have completed the "senior-level" exam in Bharatanatyam, and performed my traditional solo debut (Arangetram) in 2011. Since then, I have performed both dance forms extensively across India, with over 100 performances. I also received the Chiguru award from Bharatiya Kala Kendra in 2011 for my dance performances. Since moving to Montreal in 2017, I have performed at numerous events in eastern Canada, including Festival Orientalys (Montreal), Festival de L'Inde (Montreal), Collective Shivrathri (Toronto), and The Great India Festival (Ottawa). I have also conducted numerous workshops through the organization of Centre Kabir and Bharatiya Sangeetha Sangham (BSS), and as an invited artist to Cegep St. Laurent. I also received training in rhythm for Indian classical arts and continue my practice to better my musical form. I served on the board for Bharatiya Sangeetha Sangam (BSS) Montreal (2021) and as the President (2022). I have been involved in organizing the Montreal Natyanjali annual dance festival since 2020, and am presently the Artistic Coordinator for Param des Arts.

## TRAINING

### Mohiniattam

Student of *Smt. Dhanya Santhosh*

Jun 2019 - Jul 2024

Online classes **Montreal, Canada**

### Mohiniattam

Student of *Guru Smt. Usha Datar and Smt. Dhanya Santhosh*

Oct 2011 - Jul 2017

**Bengaluru, India**

### Rhythm in Indian Classical Dance

Student of *Guru Srihari Rangaswamy*

Jun 2020 - Dec 2021

Online classes **Montreal, Canada**

### Bharatanatyam

Student of *Guru Smt. Usha Datar*

Oct 2004 - Jul 2017

**Bengaluru, India**

- Completed solo debut Arangetram (2011)
- Completed Senior level exams conducted by Karnataka State Examination and Assessment Board (2009) which included training and assessment of corresponding yoga and Carnatic classical music
- Completed Junior level exams conducted by Karnataka State Examination and Assessment Board (2006) which included training and assessment of corresponding yoga and Carnatic classical music

### Bharatanatyam

Student of *Smt. Nirmala Madhava*

Oct 1996 - Apr 2004

**San Jose, U.S.A**

## RECENT RELEVANT PERFORMANCES IN CANADA

### *Festival de L'Inde, Montreal*

Jul 2024

- Performed duet with Maitri Arya as AryaSisters

- Organized by International Society for Krishna Consciousness (ISKCON), Montreal

#### ***Maha Bharatotsav, Ottawa***

*Aug 2023*

- Performed duet with Maitri Arya as AryaSisters
- Organized by The Great India Festival (TGIF), Ottawa

#### ***Collective Shivarathri, Toronto***

*Feb 2023*

- Performed solo Bharatanatyam
- Organized by Anandam Dance, Toronto

#### ***Seasons and Sensations, Montreal***

*May 2022*

- Conceptualized, choreographed, and performed Mohiniattam in collaboration with dancers of other Indian classical dance forms, i.e. Bharatanatyam, Odissi, and Kathak
- Two-hour long production
- Curated by Centre Kabir, Montreal

#### ***Festival Orientalys - Edition Numerique, Montreal***

*Sep 2020*

- Performed Mohiniattam solo
- Organized by Alchimes, Créations et Cultures

### **RELEVANT WORKSHOPS**

---

#### ***Mohiniattam Workshop***

*Oct 2024*

- Duet workshop with Julie Beaulieu (Bharatanatyam) to demonstrate the techniques and the similarities and differences in the techniques between Bharatanatyam and Mohiniattam
- Conducted at Cegep St. Laurent

#### ***Mohiniattam Lecture Demonstration***

*Oct 2024*

- Covered the theory of expression (Abhinaya) and the nine emotions (Navarasas) in workshop titled: *Abhinaya, the art of expression through Mohiniattam*
- Organized by Centre Kabir, Montreal

#### ***Bharatanatyam Lecture Demonstration***

*Jul 2024*

- Covered the basics of Bharatanatyam - nrutha, naatya, and nritya, and theory of eye, neck, head, and hand movements. Incorporated factors of expression in an interactive session.
- Conducted at CHSLD Vigi Pierrefonds - Assisted Living Facility, with limited mobility audience members
- Organized by Bharatiya Sangeetha Sangam (BSS), Montreal and the Town of Pierrefonds-Roxboro

### **RELEVANT SERVICE**

---

- **Jan 2023 - present:** Artistic Coordinator, Param des Arts
- **Oct 2019 - Oct 2021, Oct 2022 - present:** Member of Organizing Committee, Montreal Natyanjali
- **Jun 2023 -** Co-organizer, "Breaking Barriers with Padmashree Awardee Dr. Narthaki Nataraj - The inspiring story of a TransWoman artist followed by her performance"
- **Jan 2022 - Dec 2023:** President, Bharatiya Sangeetha Sangam (BSS), Montreal
- **Jan 2021 - Dec 2022:** Director, Bharatiya Sangeetha Sangam (BSS), Montreal